Intra-Party Conflict Over Fiscal Austerity Measures*

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Abstract

Ireland's economic and financial crisis has required the passage of several increasingly austere budgets, starting in 2008, and also the legislation to create the National Asset Management Agency (NAMA) to consolidate toxic bank debts. Debates over these pieces of legislation reveals strong differences in political preferences both within parties and between parties that can be estimated by scaling the text of their legislative speeches in each debate. Moreover, because we can assume that preferences remain stable across budgets, we can use the separate debates to validate the ability of text-scaling methodologies to recover latent positions through text. Our analysis estimates legislator positions through quantitative text scaling of the budget debates of 2008-2010 plus the NAMA legislation, finding evidence of significant intra-party differences that can be explained by a variety of political and constituency-level variables.

Key Words: Budgetary debates, policy positions, text analysis.

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With the onset of the euro zone crisis in banking and sovereign debt servicing, several European parliaments have faced the necessity of passing severe austerity measures. This has split oppositions and governments, yet the institution of strict party discipline in most legislative settings means that voting will never reveal intra-party differences over austerity. To observe such differences, we need to look rather at what legislators *say* in speeches during debates on the austerity measures. What legislators signal to constituents and fellow party members through their speech contains rich information that can be analyzed to measure the differences in their underlying political preferences.

Austerity measures are a good example generally because they are plausibly about a single dimension: taking the pain and responsibility soon in order to get better later, versus short-term desires to avoid painful measures while refusing to accept responsibility.[1] Because austerity measures are neatly embodied in packages or even annual budgets, are proposed by governing parties, and are subject to fairly constrained rules of parliamentary debate, we tend to observe text generation on a single topic within a fairly regulated format. The potential to estimate "ideal points" from text as latent traits to be estimated or scaled using text as data, in other words, has maximum potential in the arena of debates over austerity measures. Furthermore, understanding positioning in and ultimately the outcomes of these highly significant debates is crucial to understanding the means to implement successfully such difficult but necessary measures. Successful measurement of intra-party differences in this context thus serves as both an ideal methodological validation of the ability to scale underlying positions from texts using statistical methods, as well as helping to understand the dynamics of support and opposition to one of the most difficult political and economic challenges of the decade.

[1] Parliamentary speech has been analyzed previously with an aim to locating legislators' policy preferences but the dimensions of policy measured in these applications has been less than clear. In Monroe and Maeda (2004), the primary dimension that emerged from a two-dimensional scaling model of US Senate speeches was labelled the "workhorse/show-horse" dimension, for want of a better interpretation. Proksch and Slapin (2010) had to interpret their single estimated dimension from the European Parliament by resorting to correlations with roll-call vote analysis and independent expert surveys. Such problems point to a need for scaling models that take a different approach to dimensionality, namely one where plausible positioning on an *a priori* dimension is used to anchor the analysis. Alternatively, a careful selection of texts to limit speeches to a particular (one-dimensional) policy context where the primary axis of difference is known would make it much easier to interpret scales *ex post*.

Our testing ground comes from one of the first European states to experience a deep banking crisis and receive a multi-billion euro bailout with austerity conditions attached: Ireland. Since 2008, the country experienced a steep decline in economic output and a sharp rise in unemployment, and a massive debt problem caused by the financial load of recapitalizing a failing banking system. This forced the government to implement a number of severe austerity measures against growing public resentment, ultimately leading to a record low in the popularity ratings for the government parties and a breakdown of the coalition between Fianna Fáil and the Green party in January 2011.

In what follows, we outline this crisis and partisan responses to austerity measures that it required. Using the debates over four Irish budgets (2008–2011) and the passage of the legislation creating the National Asset Management Agency (NAMA), we then identify the positions of individual legislators in each debate. In future research, we also plan to explain the deviations by individual TDs from the positions of party leaders—as evidenced in their speeches—as a function of constituency and office-related characteristics.

Partisan Responses to Economic Crisis

The collapse of the property market and the banking crisis together with the difficulties of the global financial markets led to the worst economic crisis in the history of Ireland. Its economic output contracted by about 3 per cent in 2008 and 8 per cent in 2009; unemployment increased from 4.6 per cent at the end of 2007 to almost 14 per cent in 2010; government deficit climbed to 12 per cent of GDP (four times above the European Union's requirement for euro countries), and debt (as per cent of GDP) increased from 25 and 44 per cent in 2007 and 2008, respectively, to 65 per cent in 2009.[2] At the end of 2010, government debt has accumulated to €148 billion or 96 per cent of GDP (Bergin et al., 2011, 53).

To stabilize the deficit, the Irish government released a number of severe and highly controversial austerity measures, embodied in the budgets adopted since 2008. The total

[2] "Irish Economy" published by *The Economic and Social Research Institute* (http://www.esri.ie/irish_economy/, accessed April 19, 2011).

amount of implemented austerity measures between 2008 and 2011, which includes significant increases in taxes and cutbacks in social spending, was equivalent to €20 billion (13 per cent of GDP) (Bergin et al., 2011, 51). The government furthermore created the National Asset Management Agency in 2009, a government body functioning as a "bad bank" to take on and manage risky and non-viable property development loans from Irish banks in return for government bonds. The costs of NAMA and the government's guarantee of bank liabilities ultimately led to the Irish sovereign debt crisis, which put enormous pressure on the euro zone. In November 2010, Ireland received an €85 billion rescue package from the European Union, which required the implementation of further austerity measures,

The crisis and the implementation of sever austerity measures it required led to increased tension between the political parties as well as to conflict within the parties. Our goal in this paper is to quantify inter- and intra-party conflict by measuring individual legislators' preferences towards the government's austerity measures. To do this, we must first address what we perceive as the underlying dimension of conflict and why we expect variation in legislators' preferences over this dimension.

Party competition and the politics of blame avoidance

During the period we examine, party competition took place between two principal parties, competing across the divide of government versus opposition. *Fianna Fáil* (FF), governing with its junior coalition partners the Progressive Democrats (PD) and the Green party , had presided over Ireland's unprecedented economic boom in the 1990s and early 2000s.[3] In opposition was *Fine Gael* (FG). Compared to main parties in other European countries, FG and FF are relatively similar in terms of their policy positions (Weeks, 2009; Benoit and Laver, 2005), with their primary differences based mainly on historical reasons and tradition.

Party competition in Ireland is therefore mainly between the government bloc and the opposition bloc (Hansen, 2009). This divide is also clearly reflected in legislative debates

[3]The Progressive Democrats essentially ceased to exist as a parliamentary party in 2009. The sole remaining PD cabinet member, Mary Harney, remained in office and continued to support the government as an independent.

over the budget, following the annual presentation of a budget by the Minister for Finance. During these debates, legislators are free to discuss the budget, with governing party members and ministers expressing support, and opposition parties invariably criticizing the government and its budget. Given the strong party discipline in Ireland (Gallagher, 2009), votes tend to follow strict party lines. Voting against the government's financial bill or resigning from the party are extreme measures that only a few TDs are willing to do. Party discipline in Ireland, indeed, makes the two equivalent, since voting against the party on a budget would result in expulsion from the party.

Legislative speech, however, is less constrained. The electoral system gives TDs strong incentives to promote their constituency interests and to cultivate a personal vote (Gallagher and Komito, 2009; Marsh, 2007). The strong tie between legislators and their constituents therefore makes TDs vulnerable to public resentment resulting from unpopular policies. In their time allocated for speaking in the budget debates, legislators have both a motive and an opportunity to voice relative levels of support or disagreements, nuances, or other pertinent concerns, and have these views go on public record. Legislators signal these differences not only to constituents but also to fellow party members. Speeches offer the chance to cast a reluctant vote, or to display one's ministerial credentials, or to indicate the level of vociferousness of an opposition member's attitude against the government. For a variety of reasons, therefore, what legislators *say* has the potential to reveal important intra-party differences.

Because the implementation of unpopular policies puts enormous pressure on government parties and individual legislators, creating tensions between and within parties, debates over austerity budgets present an ideal opportunity for manifesting intra-party differences. In parliamentary systems like Ireland, where budgets are written entirely by the party in government, votes on these national fiscal plans are very much votes for or against the government itself, and indeed were the government to lose such a vote, it would fall and a new coalition would have to be formed (Gallagher, Laver and Mair, 2011). Because the governing FF party had been responsible for policies enacted during Ireland's economic boom — and therefore held responsible for its financial crisis following the boom — the adoption of

austerity budgets was also very much a vote on the responsibility of the government for the crisis. Relative support for austerity measures in the budgets during the period we examine, therefore, combines support for government's ability to guide the Irish economy out of the crisis with the desire to move on to solving the problems rather than identifying blame. Relative opposition to the budgets, on the other hand, signals a rejection of the government's competence to resolve the crisis, as well as a rejection of the perceived injustice of having society bear the costs of hard-biting austerity plans necessitated by the government's irresponsible financial management during the economic boom. Our argument, in a nutshell, is that legislators, and particularly backbenchers, engaged in "blame avoidance" (Pierson, 1996) by distancing themselves from the proposed austerity measures, motivated by constituents that are more sensitive to losses than to gains (Weaver, 1986, 373). Because it involves imposing tangible losses on constituents in exchange for diffuse and uncertain gains, the politics of austerity are "treacherous" (Pierson, 1996, 145) and divisive. Speeches over austerity budgets offer opposition a "blood in the water" opportunity to apportion blame to the ruling coalition, and present chances for governing parties forced to support the budgets a chance to position themselves verbally to avoid blame.

Our argument is best illustrated by the events that surrounded the announcement of the first emergency budget in 2008. Ireland officially entered recession in mid-2008, leading to the announcement of an early budget in October 2008 for the fiscal year 2009. The budget proposal, which was introduced by Finance Minister Brian Lenihan (FF), called for cuts in health spending, a reintroduction of university fees, and a one per cent levy on income. The *Irish Times* called it the "harshest budget in a generation".[4] Unexpected and widespread public outrage erupted over the government's decision to abolish the automatic entitlement to a medical card – the free and universal access to health care services– for those over 70 years. This led to increased tension between the coalition parties and between Fianna Fail backbenchers and their party leadership.

The Green party publicly criticized the government for the way it handled the medical

[4]Irish Times, "Income levy to affect every taxpayer in tough Budget", October 15, 2008, retrieved online at http://www.irishtimes.com/newspaper/frontpage/2008/1015/1224020737770.html on October 13, 2011.

card controversy, accusing it for causing "unnecessary distress and confusion amongst our older people and their families".[5] Fianna Fail backbenchers revolted against the proposed austerity measures and a small group of backbenchers even threatened to vote against the government in an upcoming motion put forward by the opposition parties. One TD resigned from the party and joined the opposite side as an independent. The authority of Brian Cowan, Taoiseach and FF party leader, and the stability of the government were called into doubt.[6] In the end, the government backed down and modified some of its measures.[7]

The medical card reversal presents but one example of legislators trying to avoid public resentment resulting from unpopular budget cuts. It illustrates the dilemma that each government TD faces: one the one hand, they must stick to the party line and defend the austerity measures. On the other hand, they are pressured by their constituents to act against the government's policies. Especially in systems combining strong party discipline with a strong personal vote, the politics of austerity create strong counter-pressures on individual members of ruling parties both to follow the party line and to engage in blame avoidance to avoid punishment by local constituents. Deputy Michael Kennedy of FF—a true politician's politician—for example remarked the following in his speech on the medical card issue:

> I am greatly relieved by this mornings decision to change the budget measures on medical cards. [...] *In lobbying hard last week for the changes to the medical card, I was conscious of the enormous number of views being expressed to me* and, indeed, to all Deputies. As a Fianna Fáil backbencher I broadly welcome the changes now made to the medical card. [emphasis added]

Because one of a legislator's principals is a local constituency, and local constituencies vary, the acuteness of each TD's dilemma will also vary with the characteristics of his or her local supporters. A legislator's other principal, of course, is the party. Consequently, we expect that a legislator's counter-pressure to toe the party line—even verbally—will also vary with his or her position within the party or within government. Cabinet members are

[5] Green party spokeswoman Deirdre de Búrca, quoted in the Irish Times, "Greens criticise way medical card issue was handled", October 21, 2008, retrieved online at http://www.irishtimes.com/newspaper/ireland/2008/1021/1224454426027.html on October 13, 2011.

[6] Irish Times, "Chaos in FF calls Cowen's authority into question", October 20, 2008, retrieved online at http://www.irishtimes.com/newspaper/opinion/2008/1020/1224279464929.html on October 13, 2011.

[7] Irish Times, "Government backs down on medical cards and 1% levy", October 22, 2008, retrieved online at http://www.irishtimes.com/newspaper/frontpage/2008/1022/1224625076839.html on October 13, 2011.

much more constrained than backbenchers to oppose the budget, as the doctrine of collective cabinet responsibility prevents ministers from publicly opposing government decisions.[8]

Data: Irish Budget Speeches, 2008–2011

Our analysis includes four budget debates (2008–2011) and the 2009 debate surrounding the creation of the National Asset Management Agency (NAMA). We label budget debates based on the fiscal year to which they apply, even though the parliamentary debates take place at the end of the previous year. We collected all speeches from the on-line version of the official parliamentary records, cleaning them as necessary and aggregating texts from a single speaker (removing interruptions, for instance). Full descriptive data on the texts and their contents are provided in the Appendix.

Budget 2008

The first debate in our analysis is the 2008 budget, which was held in December of 2007. This was the last budget before Ireland officially went into recession. We therefore expect less intra-party conflict over this budget than in the austerity budgets of the following years.

Budget 2009

We have already discussed the 2009 budget above.

NAMA (2009)

In 2009, the government confronted a banking crisis caused by massive growth in property-related lending to individuals with poor quality of credit appraisal. This led to the creation of the National Asset Management Agency (NAMA), which would buy toxic loans from participating banks at an "appropriate discount".[9] NAMA was highly controversial from

[8] In future work, we will test the above conjectures empirically by collecting data about the socio-demographic composition of each each constituency and with biographical information about deputies.

[9] National Treasury Management Agency press release, April 8, 2009

the very beginning. Fine Gael party leader Enda Kenny called it "unfair and unwise" and accused the government for transferring "the responsibility for dealing with toxic loans from the banks who made them, and the investors who funded them, to the Irish taxpayer".[10] His party proposed to establish a "national recovery bank" that would buy new loans from banks rather than old and risky ones, while the Labour Party proposed a temporary nationalization of banks.[11] Parties also disagreed over the definition of "appropriate discount" at which NAMA would buy existing loans from banks.

Principal debate on the NAMA bill took place from mid-September to mid-October 2009, and approved by the parliamentary vote on November 22.[12] Our collection of texts on the NAMA debate includes all parliamentary speeches that were made during the second reading of the bill between September 16 and October 14, 2009. In total, 94 individual contributions were made during the debate, which covers about two thirds of the 166 members of parliament.

Budget 2010

The 2010 budget introduced even further austerity measures and was considered one of the harshest budgets in the history of the Republic. To get deficit under control, government decided to cut spending by 4 billion Euro, which was partly achieved by saving €1 billion on public sector salaries (a decrease by 5 to 15 per cent) and by drastically reducing social welfare spending by €760 million (4.1 per cent). Other main measures included a reduction of child benefits by up to 10 per cent, benefit cuts for young unemployed, the introduction of a carbon tax equivalent to €15 per tonne, and a decrease of the VAT rate (sales tax) by half a point from 21.5 to 21 per cent.

Every party leader as well as the Taoiseach made, in addition to the Minister of Fi-

[10] Enda Kenny as quoted in *The Irish Times* on August 21, 2009 (http://www.irishtimes.com/newspaper/breaking/2009/0821/breaking38.html, accessed April 18, 2010)

[11] Labour Party press release from July 30, 2009

[12] The NAMA bill was finally published on September 10, 2009. The second reading of the bill in parliament started on September 16 with a speech by the Minister of Finance Brian Lenihan. The bill was then discussed over a time frame of about one month until it was approved and sent to the committee stage on October 14. It was approved by parliament on November 22 and, after it has been reviewed by the Seanad (Ireland's upper house), signed by the president on November 22.

nance, a contribution to the debate. Other speakers included the financial spokesperson of each opposition party,[13] as well as other senior members from each opposition party.[14] The speeches of the financial spokespersons were limited to 45 minutes and all other speeches to 40 minutes, though some speakers shared their time with other members.[15]

Budget 2011

This is a really important one to describe in some context, namely that it was the last budget before the incumbent government went to the chopping block in an election scheduled to take place almost immediately following the final passage of the budget.

Methods: Poisson Word-Frequency Model of Latent Positions

We estimated legislator positions in the budgetary and NAMA debates using the "wordfish" method of Slapin and Proksch (2008) to estimate one-dimensional latent positions in the budget debates. In this model, our objective is to estimate a set of latent one-dimensional positions θ_i for each legislator i, measured separately for each debate. Each β_j measures the responsiveness of observed word frequencies to the positions θ_i, apart from a word fixed effect ψ_j. To control for document length, we also estimate a document-level fixed effect α_i. The model is:

$$\begin{aligned} P(Y_{ij} \mid \theta_i) &= \text{Poisson}(Y_{ij}; \lambda_{ij}) \\ \log \lambda_{ij} &= \alpha_i + \psi_j + \beta_j \theta_i \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

[13] Richard Bruton (FG and opposition spokesperson on finance), Joan Burton (Labour), and Arthur Morgan (Sinn Fein)

[14] These included Kieran O'Donnell (deputy financial spokesperson of FG), Michael D. Higgins (Labour Party president), Ruairi Quinn (Labour Party and former Minister of Finance), Eamon Ryan (Green Party and Minister for Communications, Energy and Natural Resource), and Ciaran Cuffe (Green Party).

[15] Enda Kenny with Kieran O'Donnell; Eamon Gilmore with Michael D. Higgins and Ruairi Quinn; John Gormley with Eamon Ryan and Ciaran Cuffe.

Estimation is done through conditional maximum likelihood.[16] The direction of the scale was set to Eamon Gilmore (the Labour Party leader) representing a position numerically less than that of Fianna Fáil party leader and Taoiseach Brian Cowan.

To reduce the number of word-level parameters and improve processing times, we stemmed the texts using a standard Porter stemming algorithm[17] We did not eliminate any words based on "stop lists" or low frequencies. This contrasts with Slapin and Proksch (2008) who reduced their texts somewhat by eliminating words that appeared fewer than 5 times or in fewer than 2 documents.

The full description of the total words ("tokens"), total unique words ("types"), and mean and median word frequencies are detailed in the Appendix, for both the stemmed and unstemmed versions of the texts.

In future work, we will also consider estimating a single set of latent positions θ_i for each speaker i, assumed to be constant across debates. This is made possible because of the large number of speakers who participated in more than one debate (see the Appendix for full details). Since we are observing five budget speeches but largely for the same individual legislators, let us assume that each legislator's preference on austerity as expressed in their speeches is fixed. Word associations with these positions, however, vary with each debate, due to budget-specific factors that cause the lexicon of austerity to shift.

In this case we can modify the parametric scaling model developed by Slapin and Proksch (2008) to add a budget-specific set of word effects β_{jt}, where t indexes the successive debates. Because the fixed document effects α_{it} will remain document specific, these are also treated individually. The word fixed effects ψ_j remain attributes of words spanning debates, however, as language frequency effects are likely to be time-invariant word attributes. Finally, the object of inference, the unobserved latent positions θ_i, are assumed to be time-invariant.

[16] Using the R package `austin`.

[17] To implement this we used Will Lowe's `JFreq` utility for converting all texts into word frequency matrixes.

This yields the model:

$$\begin{aligned} P(Y_{ijt} \mid \theta_i) &= \text{Poisson}(Y_{ijt}; \lambda_{ijt}) \\ \log \lambda_{ij} &= \alpha_{it} + \psi_j + \beta_{jt}\theta_i \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

But let us reiterate that Equation 2 is for future work, and does not represent the model estimated here.

Preliminary Results

We estimated speaker positions on a debate-by-debate basis. Following estimation, we depicted these estimates in three ways:

1. Evaluating the positions of each party based on aggregated positions of individual scores.

2. Evaluating the scored positions for face validity given our strong substantive knowledge of the speakers' positions based on media reports as well as our reading of the speeches themselves.

3. Comparing differences in adjacent debates for evidence of changes in position.

This results in sets of plots like Figures 1, 2, and 3. The first applied to all five debates, while the last two (for illustration) focus on the 2011 budget.

*** FIGURE 1 ABOUT HERE ***

In Figure 1, we depict the party positions as box plots for each debate, based on the estimated positions of the legislators. In all but the 2008 and 2009 budget debates, the most supportive party was the governing FF. Opposition positions were invariably taken by Labour and FG, also as expected. We are not completely sure how to explain the SF position, and have put this on the list for future investigation.

The box plots do show considerable intra-party differences, with these differences declining in the debates over the 2010 and 2011 budgets. This means there will be ample

variation to explain in our next (unwritten) section.

*** FIGURE 2 ABOUT HERE ***

Turning to the positions of individual legislators, Figure 2 shows the positions of each legislator on a normalized scale where negative positions represent opposition to, and positive values represent support for, the government-backed austerity measures. Each solid line represents the analytic 95% confidence interval from the Poisson scaling model shown in Equation 1. Legislator positions are grouped by party.

Two patterns are evident from Figure 2. First, support and opposition to the 2011 budget group in clearly recognizable blocs by party: the coalition parties FF and the Greens are the most supportive, followed by independents in the middle, followed by FG and Labour in opposition. The two SF deputies are the most opposed to the passage of the 2011 budget.

The results are amazingly consistent with our knowledge of the speakers' actual positions from reading the texts. Generally, the Fianna Fail (FF) positions are the most pro-budget, as would be expected given that Brian Lenihan was the Minister for Finance who presented the budget. The two opposition parties, Fine Gael (FG) and Labour were strongly opposed to the budget, especially Labour who was stridently against the harsh reductions in social spending it called for. Sinn Fein was most strongly against the 2011 budget. The Green Party, on the other hand, while left on most measures of economic policy, had to support the budget as Fianna Fail's junior coalition partner.

Second, there exist considerable intra-party differences in positioning, even among the governing parties. On the opposition side, two deputies—FG's Denihan and Barrett in particular—spoke more like FF members than FG members. (We do not offer an explanation for these differences at this stage.)

*** FIGURE 3 ABOUT HERE ***

Finally, Figure 3 plots the differences between adjacent debates in 2010 and 2011, for those deputies who participated in both. Interestingly, the hard support shown in 2010 by Cowan and Lenihan (FF) appeared more moderated in 2011, with Gormley (Green) being expressing a more pro-budget view in 2011 than either Cowan or Lenihan. Other speaker positions were remarkably consistent, with the exception of SF's O'Caolain whose expressed

views had been more moderate over the 2010 budget.

See our other Figures too!

*** ALL OTHER FIGURES MORE OR LESS ABOUT HERE ***

Explaining Intra-Party Differences

To be written. To explain deviations from leaders' positions, we are gathering:

- full data on office positions among the FF party speakers (**complete**);
- data on opposition party positions (spokespersons, leaders, etc.);
- electoral variables such as margin of votes (**complete**);
- demographic information that might indicate the vulnerability of local constituencies to austerity, such as unemployment, the percentage of welfare recipients, etc.

Conclusions

We conclude the following:

- There is indeed positional information on a uni-dimensional latent scale of support for versus opposition to austerity measures, as expressed in the budget speeches.
- These positions are measured with a high degree of face validity and consistency across debates, when measured separately using the Poisson scaling model.
- Parties may vote as a unified block due to party discipline, but the degree of expressed support for austerity measures varies widely across party members, and we hope to show, in ways that can be explained using political and demographic variables specific to each speaker's constituency.

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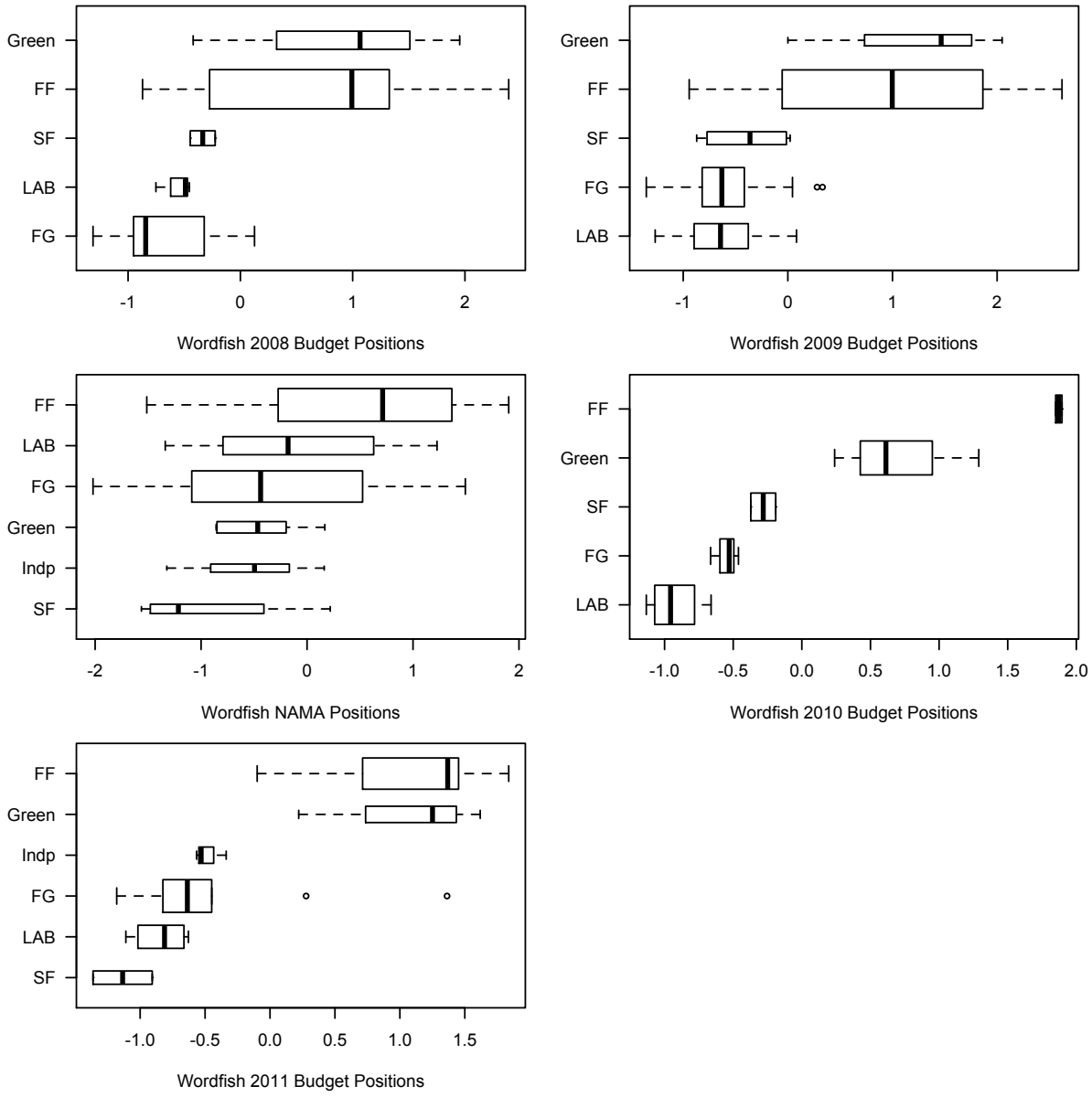


Figure 1: *Wordfish Estimates of Party Positions on all Debates.*

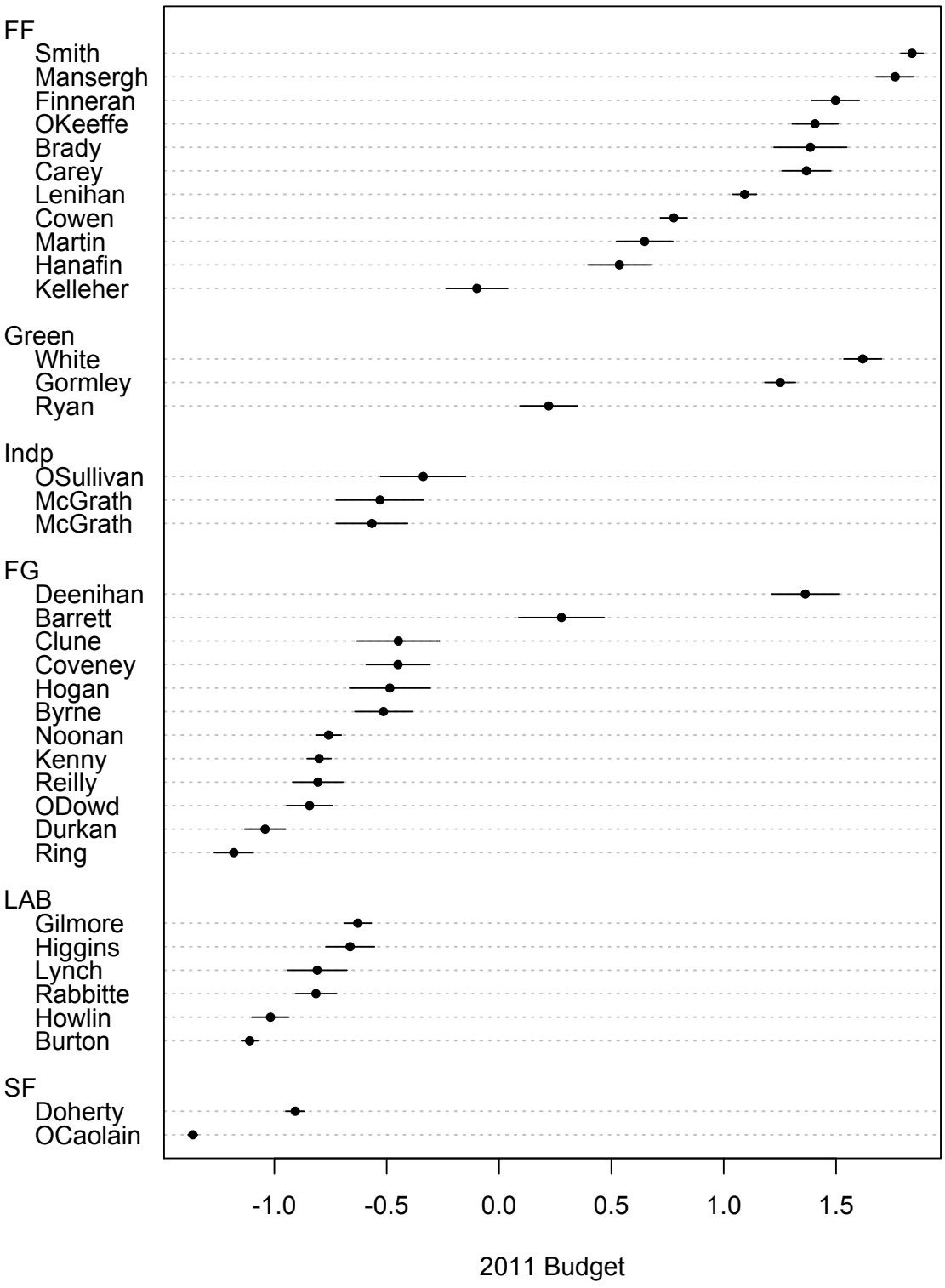


Figure 2: *Wordfish Estimates for the Budget Debates 2011.*

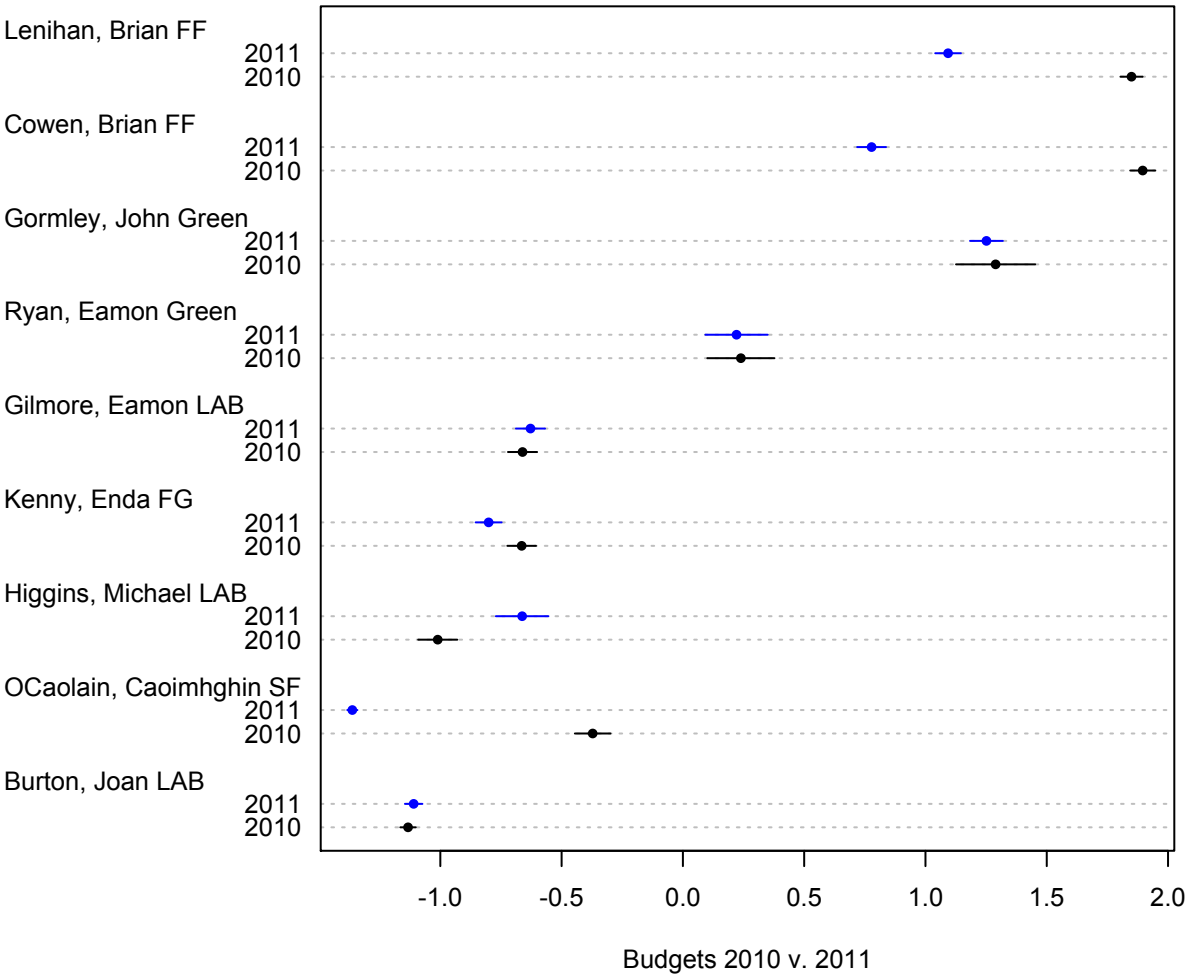


Figure 3: *Budget 2010 v. 2011 Estimated Positions.*

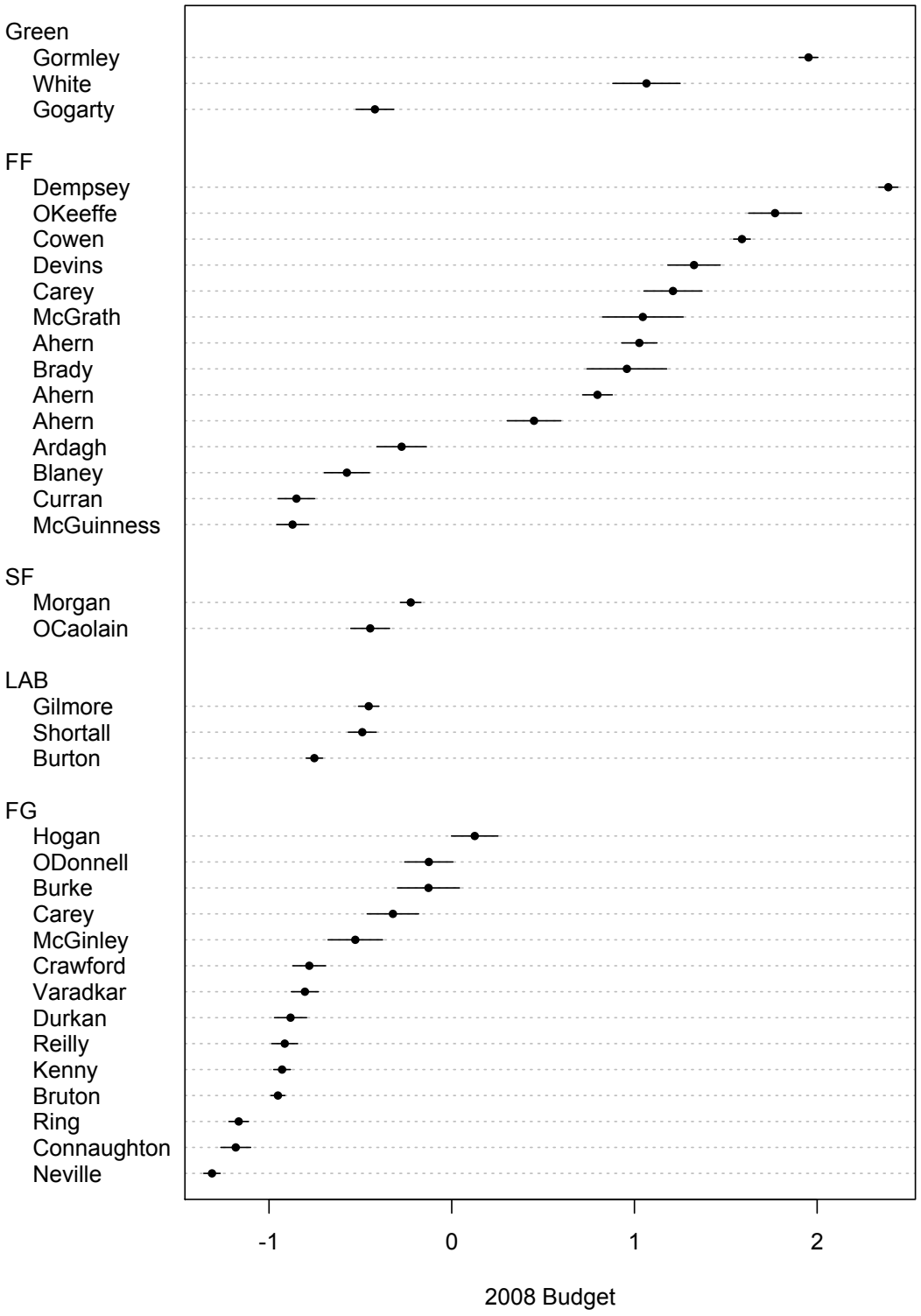


Figure 4: *Wordfish Estimates for the Budget Debates 2008.*

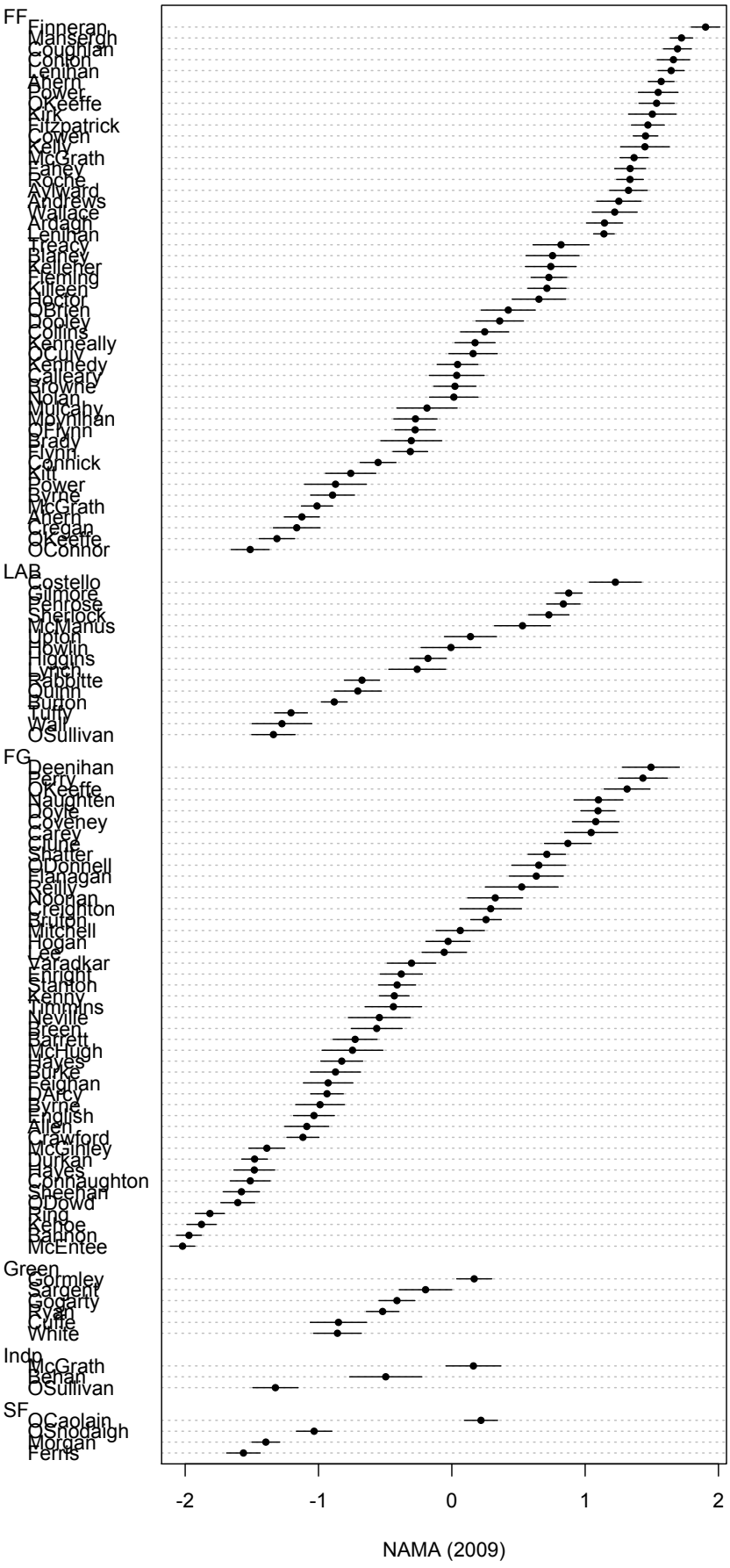


Figure 5: *Wordfish Estimates for the (2009) NAMA Debates.*

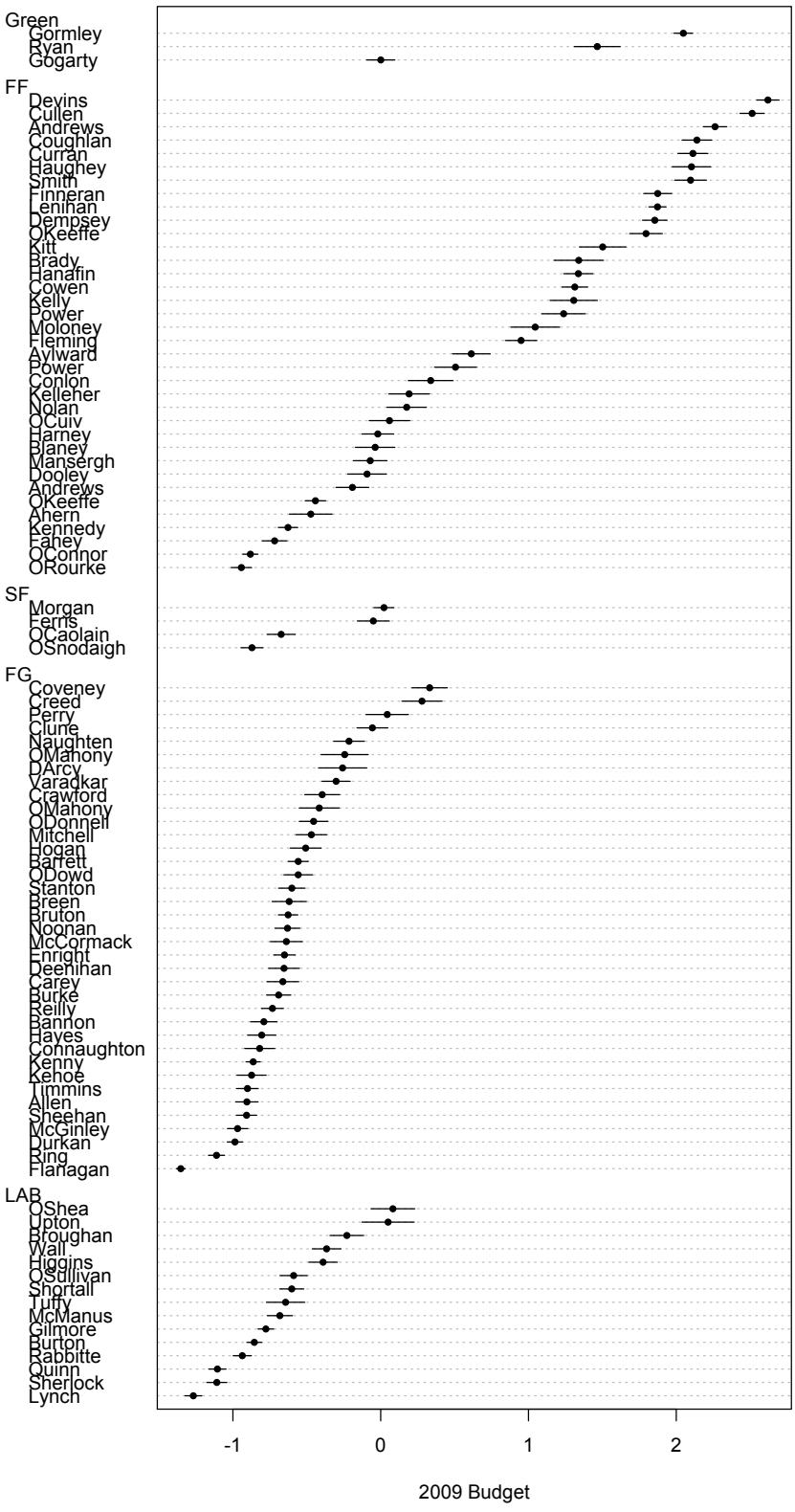


Figure 6: *Wordfish Estimates for the Budget Debates 2009.*

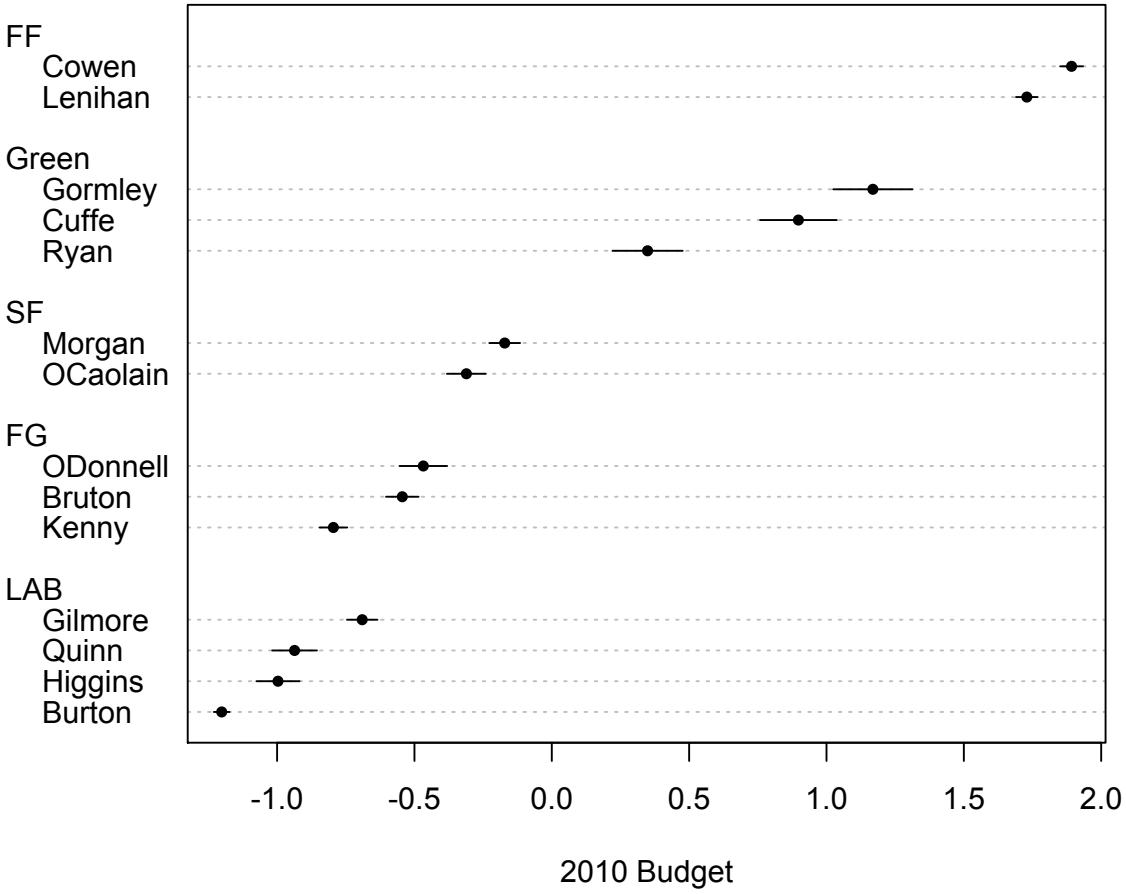


Figure 7: *Wordfish Estimates for the Budget Debates 2010.*

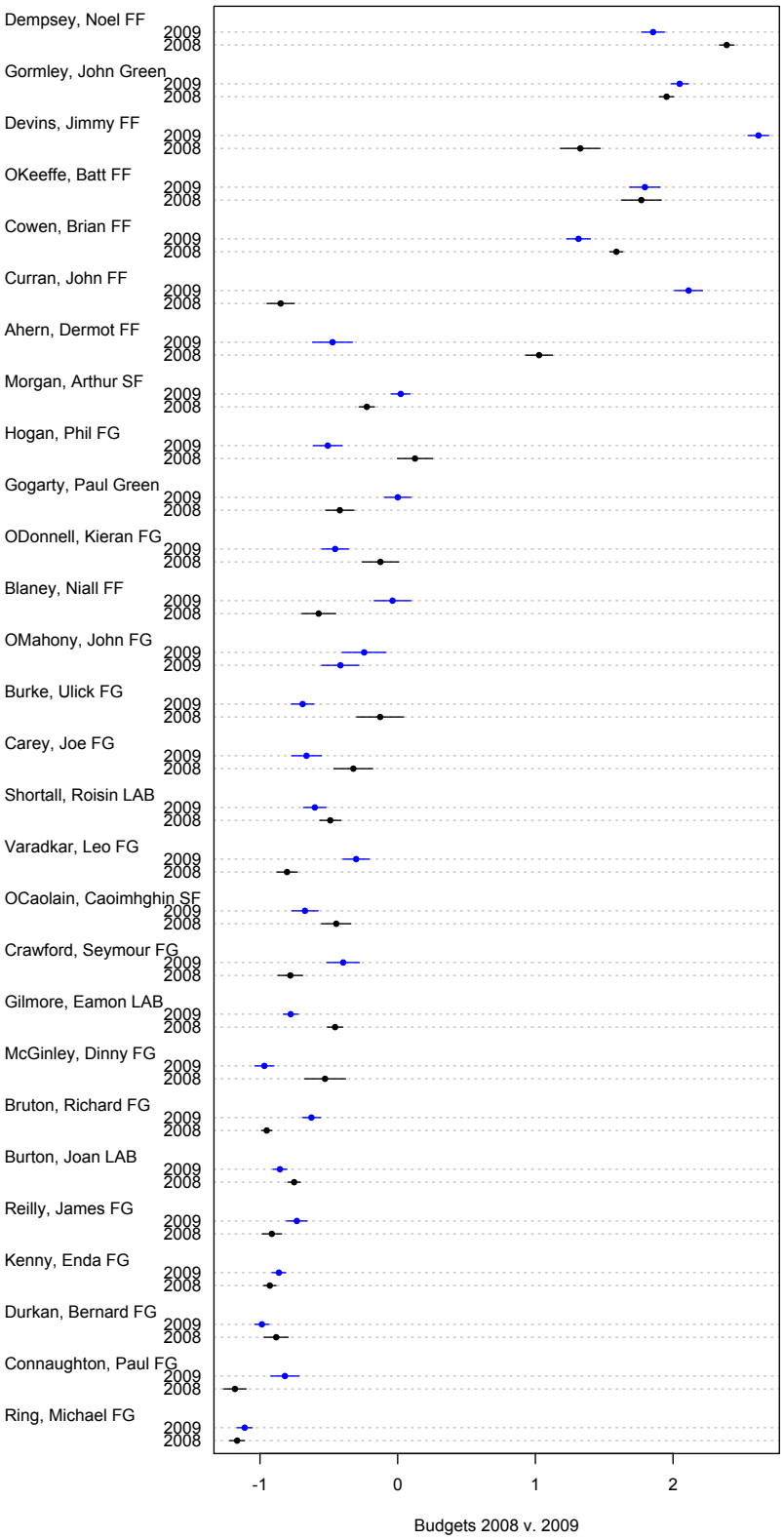


Figure 8: *Budget 2008 v. Budget 2009 Estimated Positions.*

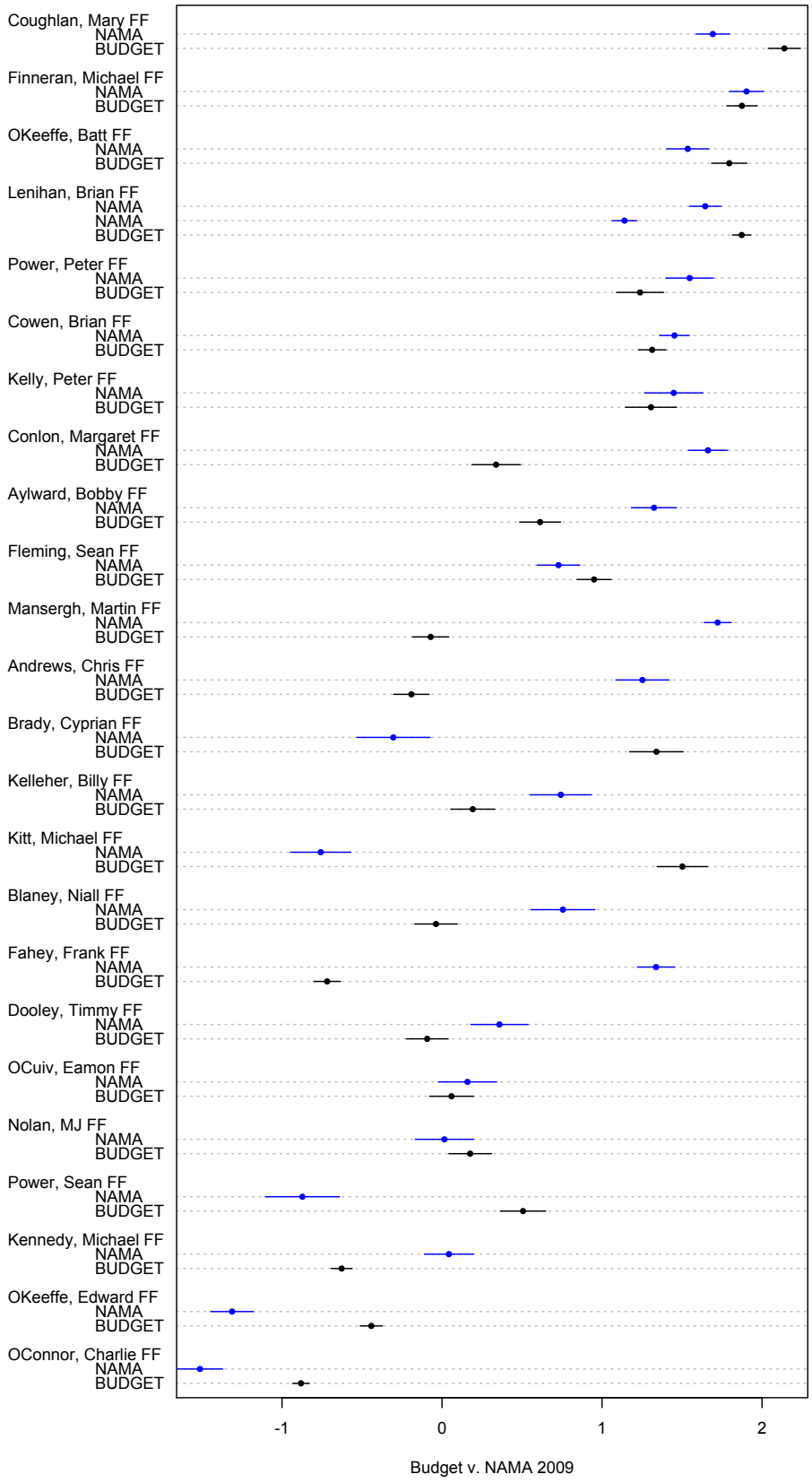


Figure 9: *Budget 2009 v. NAMA Estimated Positions, Fianna Fail.*

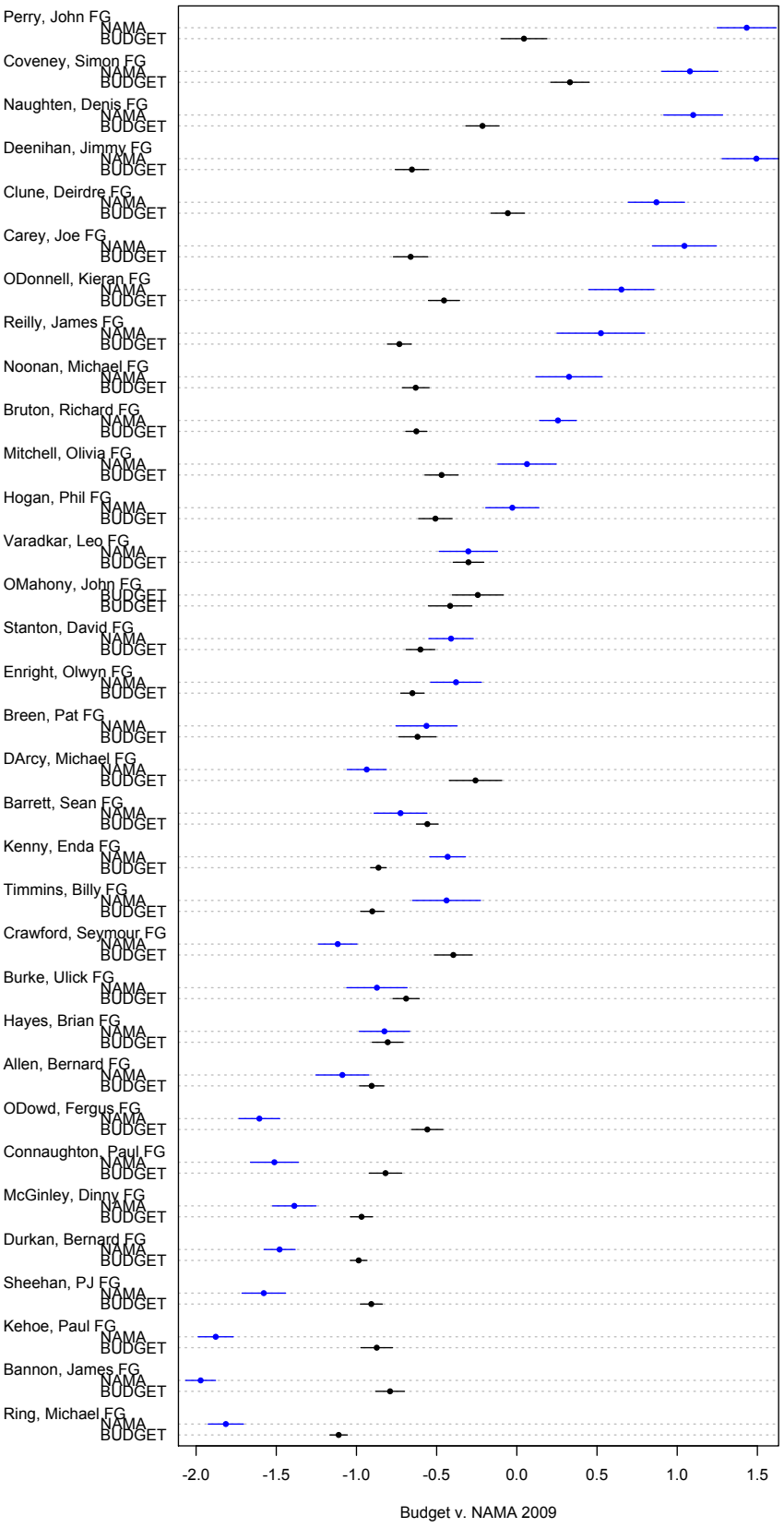


Figure 10: *Budget 2009 v. NAMA Estimated Positions, Fine Gael.*

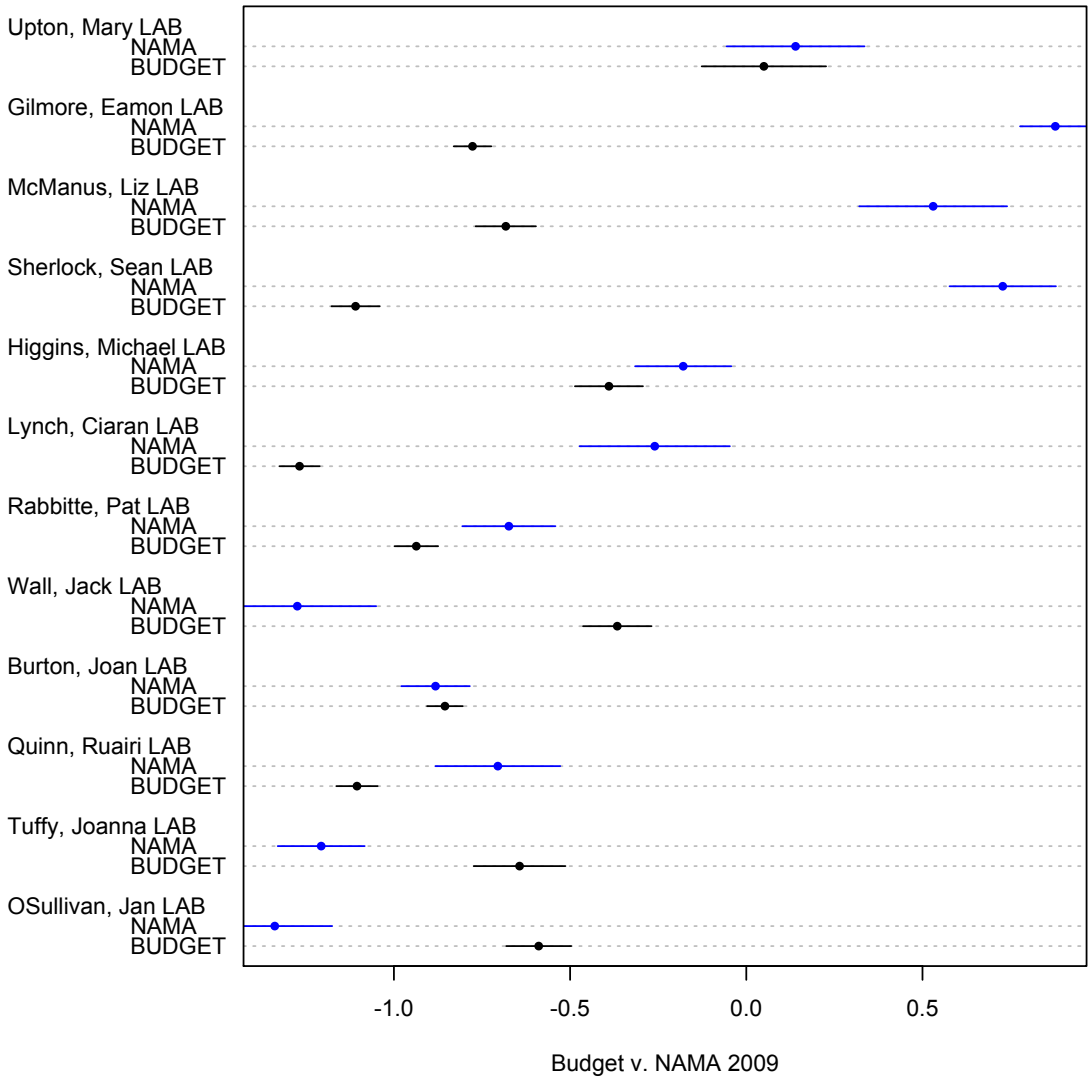


Figure 11: *Budget 2009 v. NAMA Estimated Positions, Labour.*

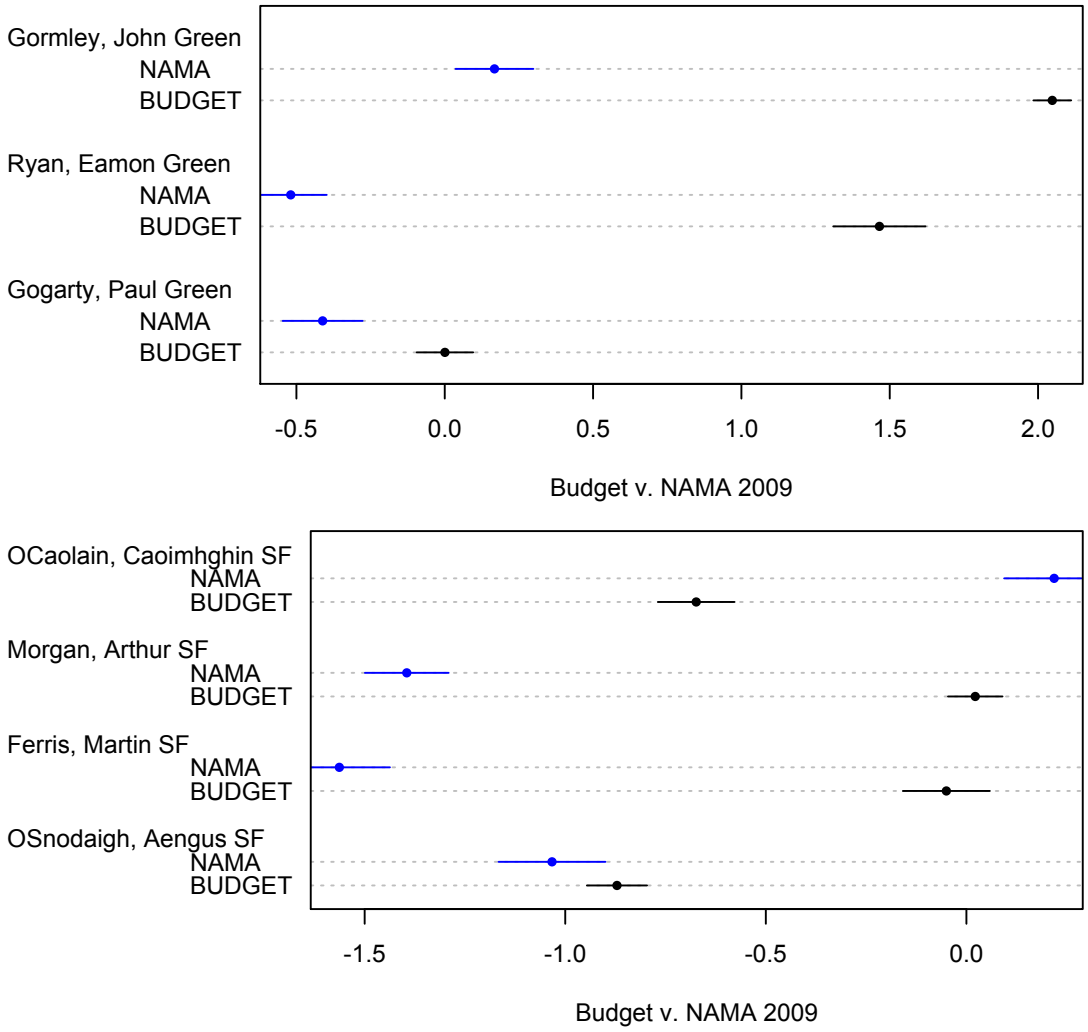


Figure 12: *Budget 2009 v. NAMA Estimated Positions, Greens and Sinn Fein.*

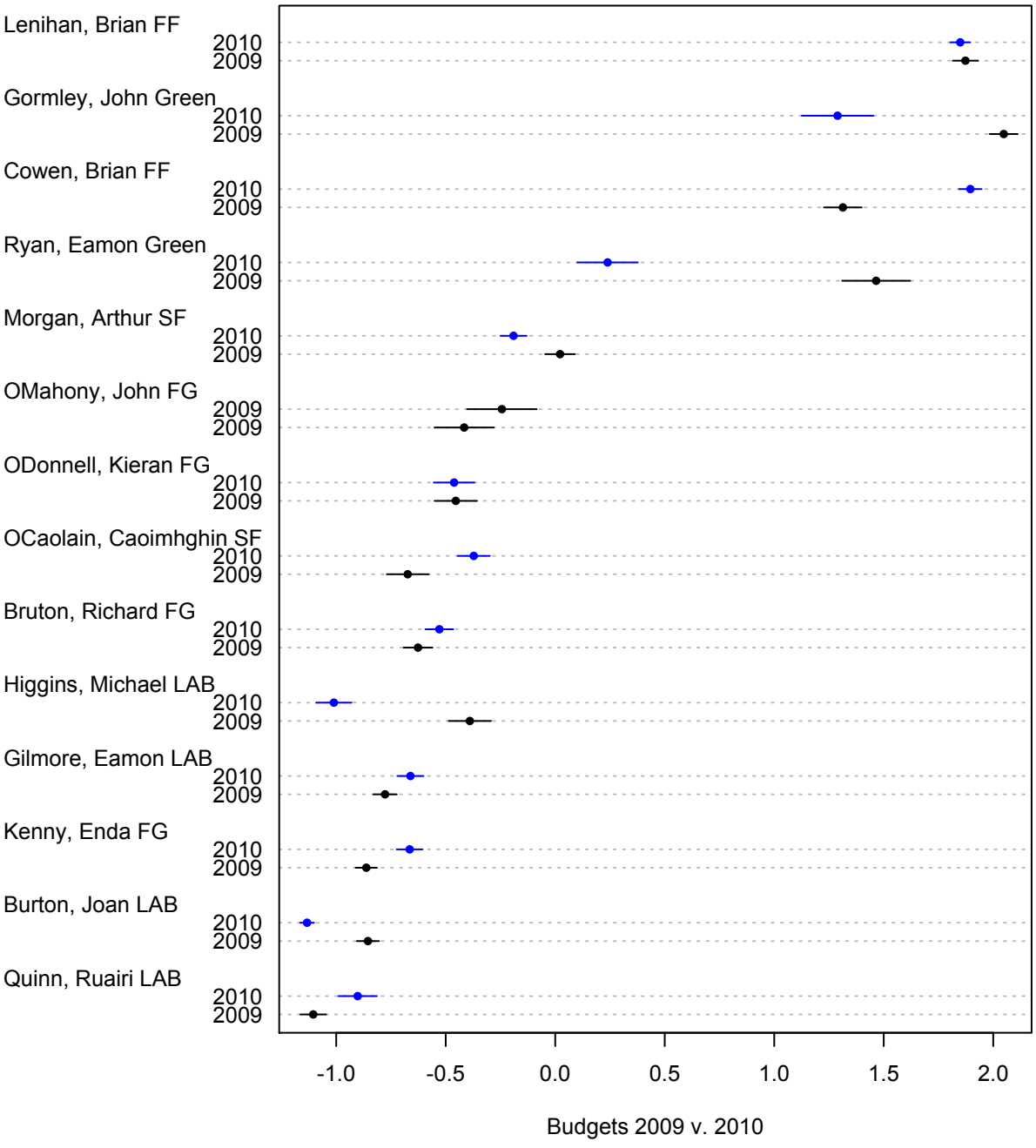


Figure 13: *Budget 2009 v. 2010 Estimated Positions.*

Appendix A: Summary Data on Speeches

Name	Party	2008			NAMA			2009			2010			2011			Total Words	Total Speeches
		Tokens	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*		
Ahern, Bertie	FF	3,933	1,044	869	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,846	1
Ahern, Dermot	FF	2,689	677	548	.	.	.	877	377	355	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,523	2
Ahern, Michael	FF	1,186	475	429	2,783	818	708	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,399	2
Ahern, Noel	FF	.	.	.	2,157	668	590	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,415	1
Allen, Bernard	FG	.	.	.	1,402	538	489	1,570	589	532	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,120	2
Andrews, Barry	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,825	721	589	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,135	1
Andrews, Chris	FF	.	.	.	1,398	509	464	1,919	626	561	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,477	2
Ardagh, Sean	FF	1,006	393	354	2,302	635	554	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,244	2
Aylward, Bobby	FF	.	.	.	1,792	677	610	1,978	687	615	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,359	2
Bannon, James	FG	.	.	.	1,351	534	489	1,430	572	525	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,901	2
Barrett, Sean	FG	.	.	.	1,754	477	423	3,629	1,063	900	.	.	.	743	336	307	9,632	3
Behan, Joe	Indp	.	.	.	712	328	310	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,350	1
Blaney, Niall	FF	919	366	334	1,322	507	448	1,455	552	499	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,402	3
Brady, Cyprian	FF	.	.	.	1,052	401	359	1,134	443	403	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,792	2
Brady, Johnny	FF	537	250	238	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	556	267	247	2,095	2
Breen, Pat	FG	.	.	.	1,412	544	495	1,140	452	416	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,459	2
Broughan, Thomas	LAB	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,761	655	601	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,017	1
Browne, John	FF	.	.	.	2,319	707	608	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,634	1
Bruton, Richard	FG	5,301	1,207	1,004	4,392	1,034	848	3,491	937	800	4,043	947	790	.	.	.	24,794	4
Burke, Ulick	FG	707	316	291	1,248	444	404	2,035	680	614	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,739	3
Burton, Joan	LAB	5,466	1,459	1,215	4,634	1,165	986	3,940	1,182	1,027	5,728	1,471	1,246	4,640	1,236	1,055	36,450	5
Byrne, Catherine	FG	.	.	.	1,228	493	449	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,172	458	420	4,220	2
Byrne, Thomas	FF	.	.	.	1,609	482	425	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,516	1
Calleary, Dara	FF	.	.	.	1,368	497	453	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,318	1
Carey, Joe	FG	899	376	352	1,141	488	454	1,243	515	469	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,937	3
Carey, Pat	FF	935	383	339	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,271	437	386	3,751	2
Clune, Deirdre	FG	.	.	.	1,626	556	487	2,353	706	608	.	.	.	591	271	253	7,451	3
Collins, Niall	FF	.	.	.	1,782	574	515	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,871	1
Conlon, Margaret	FF	.	.	.	1,543	568	504	1,320	516	465	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,916	2
Connaughton, Paul	FG	621	267	262	1,126	420	391	1,057	414	388	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,946	3
Connick, Sean	FF	.	.	.	2,835	891	772	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,498	1
Costello, Joe	LAB	.	.	.	1,039	418	385	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,842	1
Coughlan, Mary	FF	.	.	.	1,968	672	575	2,025	621	509	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,370	2
Coveney, Simon	FG	.	.	.	1,445	528	466	2,121	651	576	.	.	.	998	381	346	7,512	3
Cowen, Brian	FF	8,681	1,681	1,261	3,588	1,021	830	4,288	1,131	918	5,842	1,466	1,163	6,818	1,480	1,161	41,329	5
Crawford, Seymour	FG	1,318	530	486	2,590	823	717	1,422	597	540	.	.	.	.	.	.	9,023	3
Creed, Michael	FG	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,620	593	533	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,746	1
Cregan, John	FF	.	.	.	1,169	456	411	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,036	1
Creighton, Lucinda	FG	.	.	.	1,089	414	379	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,882	1

Appendix A: Summary Data on Speeches

Name	Party	2008 Tokens	2008 Types Unstemmed	2008 Types stemmed	NAMA Tokens	NAMA Types Unstemmed	NAMA Types stemmed	2009 Tokens	2009 Types Unstemmed	2009 Types stemmed	2010 Tokens	2010 Types Unstemmed	2010 Types stemmed	2011 Tokens	2011 Types Unstemmed	2011 Types stemmed	Total Words	Total Speeches
Cuffe, Ciaran	Green	.	.	.	997	431	399	.	.	.	1,141	421	376	.	.	.	3,765	2
Cullen, Martin	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,843	575	499	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,917	1
Curran, John	FF	957	368	333	.	.	.	2,053	652	544	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,907	2
DArcy, Michael	FG	.	.	.	2,835	898	784	842	352	324	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,035	2
Deenihan, Jimmy	FG	.	.	.	644	330	309	1,349	498	457	.	.	.	677	307	279	4,850	3
Dempsey, Noel	FF	1,417	467	421	.	.	.	3,708	976	819	.	.	.	.	.	.	7,808	2
Devins, Jimmy	FF	1,084	374	324	.	.	.	1,804	536	441	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,563	2
Doherty, Pearse	SF	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,888	1,329	1,086	8,303	1
Dooley, Timmy	FF	.	.	.	1,805	584	501	1,468	533	478	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,369	2
Doyle, Andrew	FG	.	.	.	2,669	888	747	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,304	1
Durkan, Bernard	FG	1,157	462	413	2,765	794	698	2,673	807	715	.	.	.	894	363	338	12,079	4
English, Damien	FG	.	.	.	1,690	476	430	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,596	1
Enright, Olwyn	FG	.	.	.	2,167	735	643	2,739	822	698	.	.	.	.	.	.	7,804	2
Fahey, Frank	FF	.	.	.	2,608	796	683	1,891	612	544	.	.	.	.	.	.	7,134	2
Feighan, Frank	FG	.	.	.	1,238	430	395	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,063	1
Ferris, Martin	SF	.	.	.	1,476	521	475	2,193	755	656	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,076	2
Finneran, Michael	FF	.	.	.	1,236	492	438	2,845	824	690	.	.	.	1,099	439	387	8,450	3
Fitzpatrick, Michael	FF	.	.	.	1,981	628	542	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,151	1
Flanagan, Charles	FG	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,729	641	581	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,951	1
Flanagan, Terence	FG	.	.	.	1,329	468	417	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,214	1
Fleming, Sean	FF	.	.	.	2,959	780	680	2,904	839	732	.	.	.	.	.	.	8,894	2
Flynn, Beverley	FF	.	.	.	3,265	908	784	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,957	1
Gilmore, Eamon	LAB	5,095	1,328	1,102	4,984	1,213	996	4,167	1,218	1,042	3,780	1,082	934	4,589	1,165	981	33,676	5
Gogarty, Paul	Green	1,546	600	535	2,959	907	787	2,921	942	794	.	.	.	.	.	.	11,991	3
Gormley, John	Green	4,260	1,072	843	3,383	996	851	5,510	1,327	1,026	919	361	328	3,731	1,013	830	26,450	5
Hanafin, Mary	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,276	771	642	.	.	.	1,334	466	417	6,906	2
Harney, Mary	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,256	628	557	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,441	1
Haughey, Sean	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,256	430	365	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,051	1
Hayes, Brian	FG	.	.	.	1,837	668	604	1,227	431	406	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,173	2
Hayes, Tom	FG	.	.	.	1,111	386	354	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,851	1
Higgins, Michael	LAB	.	.	.	3,033	889	747	2,147	735	643	1,139	437	404	1,342	539	487	12,542	4
Hoctor, Maire	FF	.	.	.	1,344	535	485	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,364	1
Hogan, Phil	FG	1,427	472	433	2,097	745	652	1,619	558	507	.	.	.	602	278	257	9,647	4
Howlin, Brendan	LAB	.	.	.	1,153	442	404	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,160	455	420	4,034	2
Kehoe, Paul	FG	.	.	.	1,173	417	386	995	393	362	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,726	2
Kelleher, Billy	FF	.	.	.	1,455	456	393	1,529	506	448	.	.	.	1,328	457	415	6,987	3
Kelly, Peter	FF	.	.	.	926	366	331	1,246	474	430	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,773	2
Kenneally, Brendan	FF	.	.	.	2,573	783	678	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,034	1
Kennedy, Michael	FF	.	.	.	2,464	695	617	3,482	918	777	.	.	.	.	.	.	8,953	2

Appendix A: Summary Data on Speeches

Name	Party	2008 Tokens	2008 Types Unstemmed	2008 Types stemmed	NAMA Tokens	NAMA Types Unstemmed	NAMA Types stemmed	2009 Tokens	2009 Types Unstemmed	2009 Types stemmed	2010 Tokens	2010 Types Unstemmed	2010 Types stemmed	2011 Tokens	2011 Types Unstemmed	2011 Types stemmed	Total Words	Total Speeches
Kenny, Enda	FG	3,887	1,086	930	4,329	1,077	901	4,201	1,162	989	3,863	1,055	911	4,414	1,139	964	30,908	5
Killeen, Tony	FF	.	.	.	2,609	723	610	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,942	1
Kirk, Seamus	FF	.	.	.	912	397	362	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,671	1
Kitt, Michael	FF	.	.	.	1,322	471	422	1,224	432	379	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,250	2
Lee, George	FG	.	.	.	2,078	566	509	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,153	1
Lenihan, Brian	FF	.	.	.	7,026	1,597	1,228	7,608	1,636	1,269	7,737	1,644	1,280	7,065	1,530	1,192	40,812	5
Lynch, Ciaran	LAB	.	.	.	1,226	480	425	770	326	305	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,532	2
Lynch, Kathleen	LAB	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	710	274	260	1,244	1
Mansergh, Martin	FF	.	.	.	2,872	911	767	1,983	720	644	.	.	.	1,005	435	400	9,737	3
Martin, Micheal	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,605	547	492	2,644	1
McCormack, Padraic	FG	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,255	476	427	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,158	1
McEntee, Shane	FG	.	.	.	1,238	441	395	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,074	1
McGinley, Dinny	FG	663	312	298	1,594	585	527	1,600	565	515	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,659	3
McGrath, Finian	Indp	.	.	.	1,376	544	493	.	.	.	.	.	.	706	297	279	3,695	2
McGrath, Mattie	FF	514	252	238	2,928	789	683	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,404	2
McGrath, Mattie	Indp	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	491	217	202	910	1
McGrath, Michael	FF	.	.	.	3,083	844	716	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,643	1
McGuinness, John	FF	1,206	405	362	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,973	1
McHugh, Joe	FG	.	.	.	906	364	336	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,606	1
McManus, Liz	LAB	.	.	.	1,275	525	479	1,909	686	619	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,493	2
Mitchell, Olivia	FG	.	.	.	1,759	572	514	1,716	572	515	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,648	2
Moloney, John	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,217	405	360	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,982	1
Morgan, Arthur	SF	6,102	1,495	1,208	2,648	754	661	5,805	1,487	1,198	6,449	1,453	1,171	.	.	.	30,431	4
Moynihan, Michael	FF	.	.	.	2,113	606	538	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,257	1
Mulcahy, Michael	FF	.	.	.	1,102	428	397	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,927	1
Naughten, Denis	FG	.	.	.	1,300	459	407	2,151	727	642	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,686	2
Neville, Dan	FG	1,203	401	355	946	379	352	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,636	2
Nolan, MJ	FF	.	.	.	1,741	565	503	1,614	520	465	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,408	2
Noonan, Michael	FG	.	.	.	1,359	477	437	2,156	704	623	.	.	.	4,265	1,097	937	12,055	3
OBrien, Darragh	FF	.	.	.	1,394	462	411	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,267	1
OCaolain, Caoimhghin	SF	1,416	515	469	3,740	1,121	943	1,550	597	549	3,629	1,035	881	5,242	1,412	1,204	24,303	5
OConnor, Charlie	FF	.	.	.	1,241	434	396	3,564	905	772	.	.	.	.	.	.	7,312	2
OCuiv, Eamon	FF	.	.	.	1,755	610	538	1,444	519	475	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,341	2
ODonnell, Kieran	FG	1,173	449	403	1,325	449	392	1,992	602	529	2,054	609	534	.	.	.	10,511	4
ODowd, Fergus	FG	.	.	.	1,366	481	441	1,773	564	502	.	.	.	1,129	448	406	7,110	3
OFlynn, Noel	FF	.	.	.	2,411	740	647	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	3,798	1
OKeeffe, Batt	FF	710	298	262	1,579	566	507	2,180	643	541	.	.	.	1,354	480	431	9,551	4
OKeeffe, Edward	FF	.	.	.	1,773	606	537	3,946	1,003	851	.	.	.	.	.	.	8,716	2
OKeeffe, Jim	FG	.	.	.	1,226	478	431	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,135	1

Appendix A: Summary Data on Speeches

		2008			NAMA			2009			2010			2011				
Name	**Party**	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	*Tokens*	*Types Unstemmed*	*Types stemmed*	**Total Words**	**Total Speeches**
OMahony, John	FG	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,064	453	419	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,936	2
ORourke, Mary	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,710	564	515	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,789	1
OShea, Brian	LAB	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,254	517	458	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,229	1
OSnodaigh, Aengus	SF	.	.	.	2,245	651	557	1,741	629	568	.	.	.	.	.	.	6,391	2
OSullivan, Jan	LAB	.	.	.	1,159	465	426	1,878	541	474	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,943	2
OSullivan, Maureen	Indp	.	.	.	1,080	465	419	.	.	.	.	.	.	616	290	275	3,145	2
Penrose, Willie	LAB	.	.	.	3,232	980	844	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,056	1
Perry, John	FG	.	.	.	933	402	357	1,318	558	507	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,075	2
Power, Peter	FF	.	.	.	1,219	451	411	1,487	498	438	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,504	2
Power, Sean	FF	.	.	.	820	348	315	1,573	548	476	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,080	2
Quinn, Ruairi	LAB	.	.	.	1,536	541	500	1,439	559	522	1,182	413	383	.	.	.	7,075	3
Rabbitte, Pat	LAB	.	.	.	2,796	878	776	2,176	737	673	.	.	.	1,504	528	493	10,561	3
Reilly, James	FG	1,673	587	530	752	323	301	2,305	659	591	.	.	.	1,008	415	384	9,528	4
Ring, Michael	FG	1,516	483	433	1,315	397	364	1,626	517	465	.	.	.	633	266	252	8,267	4
Roche, Dick	FF	.	.	.	3,532	940	777	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,249	1
Ryan, Eamon	Green	.	.	.	3,523	833	699	1,276	449	389	1,513	481	432	1,625	512	444	12,176	4
Sargent, Trevor	Green	.	.	.	1,459	509	453	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,421	1
Shatter, Alan	FG	.	.	.	2,707	831	717	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,255	1
Sheehan, PJ	FG	.	.	.	1,252	491	445	1,920	722	655	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,485	2
Sherlock, Sean	LAB	.	.	.	2,331	780	674	1,046	377	346	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,554	2
Shortall, Roisin	LAB	2,633	802	690	.	.	.	2,360	693	601	.	.	.	.	.	.	7,779	2
Smith, Brendan	FF	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,843	572	491	.	.	.	2,372	717	609	6,604	2
Stanton, David	FG	.	.	.	2,789	848	727	1,955	636	561	.	.	.	.	.	.	7,516	2
Timmins, Billy	FG	.	.	.	1,187	433	396	1,706	635	571	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,928	2
Treacy, Noel	FF	.	.	.	1,158	431	398	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,987	1
Tuffy, Joanna	LAB	.	.	.	2,283	659	568	876	335	309	.	.	.	.	.	.	5,030	2
Upton, Mary	LAB	.	.	.	1,520	602	551	873	370	342	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,258	2
Varadkar, Leo	FG	1,865	593	530	1,668	512	449	2,387	679	611	.	.	.	.	.	.	9,294	3
Wall, Jack	LAB	.	.	.	652	295	271	2,163	749	657	.	.	.	.	.	.	4,787	2
Wallace, Mary	FF	.	.	.	1,392	481	429	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	2,302	1
White, Alexandra	Green	733	316	290	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,339	1
White, Mary	Green	.	.	.	1,386	544	485	.	.	.	.	.	.	1,417	517	464	4,813	2
Total Speeches		36			94			14			37			121			997,674	304
Median words		1,262	470	425	1,543	544	489	1,824	607	541	3,705	991	836	1,271	457	417	686.5	-
Mean words		2,123.2	627	538.4	1,924.1	616	540.7	2,105.7	663	579.0	3,501.4	920	773.8	2,070.1	616	534.1	1,101.2	-